

Adding Moving Services to Your Existing Business: A Revenue Stream That Scales

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If you run a business that already has trucks, employees, and local customers — you're most of the way to a moving operation. The incremental cost to add moving services is dramatically lower than building from scratch.

Who This Is For

This is for owners of:

- Junk removal companies (you already move stuff, you already have trucks)
- Delivery businesses (same trucks, different cargo)
- Storage facilities (your customers are literally moving things in and out)
- Cleaning companies (your customers are often moving in or out)

- Landscaping and property maintenance companies (trucks, crews, and homeowner relationships)
- Handyman and home services businesses (customers who trust you with their home)

In every case, you have the infrastructure. You're missing is the moving-specific equipment, licensing, and customer acquisition system.

The Junk Removal Overlap

Junk removal and moving are natural complements. The customer base overlaps significantly — both involve people dealing with stuff in transition. Someone moving out of a house needs both junk removed and furniture moved to a new location.

Operators who offer both can serve the full customer lifecycle:

- Moving in: furniture transport from old home to new
- Living: occasional junk removal, cleanouts
- Moving out: junk removal + moving to new location

The cross-sell opportunity alone can justify the addition. A junk removal customer who's also moving is worth 2 to 4x more revenue than a one-service customer.

What you need to add:

- Moving blankets, dollies, straps (additional \$800 to \$1,500 in equipment)
- Basic cargo liability insurance for household goods (your junk removal cargo policy likely doesn't cover customer furniture)
- USDOT number for moving (may already have it)
- Staff training on furniture handling and placement

What you already have:

- Trucks (may need a box truck or smaller moving van vs. open-bed junk truck)
- Crew capable of heavy lifting
- Customer relationships

- Local market knowledge

The Storage Facility Extension

Storage facilities sit on an underutilized opportunity. Their customers are all either moving in or out — the ultimate captive market for moving services.

An operator who adds even basic local moving services to a storage facility:

- Converts the "just storage" customer into a "storage + moving" customer
- Differentiates from competitors who offer storage only
- Creates a recurring relationship beyond the storage rental

Many storage operators partner with local moving companies rather than running their own operation. But operators with existing staff and a truck (for moving heavy items to/from units) can run a basic moving service with minimal additional investment.

The Cleaning Company Connection

Move-in and move-out cleans are among the most common requests cleaning companies receive. The customer is moving — which means they also need someone to move furniture.

A cleaning company that partners with (or absorbs) a moving operation can offer a complete move-out package: pack, move, clean. Higher ticket, better customer experience, stronger differentiation.

The integration is lighter than it seems. The cleaning company handles client acquisition; the moving component is subcontracted or added with one truck and trained crew.

What You Actually Need to Add

Regardless of your existing business type, the additions are:

Equipment:

- Moving blankets (12 to 24)
- Furniture dollies (2 to 3)

- Appliance dolly
- Moving straps (4 to 6 sets)
- Stretch wrap and packing tape
- Floor runners and door protection

Total: \$1,200 to \$2,000

Licensing:

- USDOT number (free, required for commercial transport)
- State carrier permit (if not already have one, \$50 to \$500)
- For interstate: FMCSA MC authority (\$300, 4 to 6 weeks)

Insurance:

- Cargo liability for household goods: \$100 to \$300/month additional
- Verify your existing general liability covers move-related property damage

Training:

- Furniture wrapping and protection techniques
- Safe carry and placement (especially on stairs)
- Communication and customer interaction standards
- Disassembly and reassembly of standard furniture

Truck:

- If your existing trucks aren't enclosed: a used box truck runs \$15,000 to \$30,000
- If you already have enclosed trucks: add the equipment above and you're operational

Building the Revenue Case

Your existing business already has customers. Many of them will need moving services at some point.

Scenario: Junk removal company with 200 jobs/month

If 15% of junk removal customers also need moving help (conservative estimate):

- 30 additional moving jobs per month
- At \$600 average: \$18,000/month in additional revenue
- At 35% margin: \$6,300/month contribution
- Annualized: \$75,600 from one added service line

That's a meaningful revenue addition — from customers you already have.

Cross-sell approach:

After every junk removal job, ask: "Are you moving as well, or just clearing things out?" Customers who are moving will say yes. You've just opened the door to a second job from the same relationship.

The Operational Warning

Adding a service line adds operational complexity. Before scaling the moving addition:

- Keep it financially separate from day one — track moving P&L independently
- Don't let moving jobs compromise your core business quality
- Start with a small moving footprint (one truck, 2 to 4 jobs per week) before scaling
- Train crew specifically for moving — it's different from junk removal or delivery in ways that matter for customer experience

Operators who add moving services successfully treat it as a real business unit with its own systems, not a casual add-on.

Want to understand what a moving addition could generate from your existing customer base? Book a free strategy call and let's model it out.